

For students who are ready and willing to dive into learning and exploring new subjects this is not a concern. They can make use of the forums on the site or look on the Web to get doubts cleared.

Most students take these courses out of curiosity. Since the course is free, what's the harm in enrolling, right? This, of course, is not enough to carry you through the entire five to six weeks of classes.

With MOOCs the attrition rate is exceptionally high. The average student loses interest by about the second week of the course. These courses have a scary attrition rate of about 7%. However, since thousands of people actually enroll for these courses, the total number that completes them is substantial.

Grading is an issue with such a large number of students. While teaching assistants pitch in, these courses mostly rely on MCQ tests and peer assessments to grade students. This leads to an issue of properly gauging a MOOC student's in depth knowledge of a subject.

Value of a MOOC Certificate vs. Traditional Degree Certificates

MOOCs can be mentioned in your resume. They will be considered as an additional factor but not necessarily a qualifying one. However, it is very likely that a recruiter will look at you as a self starter and motivated candidate if you have a few of these on your resume. It will show that you are interested in mastering certain skills even if you have to go the extra mile to achieve it.

Statement of Accomplishment vs. Verified Certificate

A Statement of Accomplishment simply states that you have completed the course with a certain end score. All you have to do to get it is complete the course and sign an Honor Code which states that you will not cheat while attempting the course. The Statement of Accomplishment has the stamp of the site from which you have obtained the MOOC, for example Coursera.

A Verified Certificate is typically one that you get when you pay for the course. It has the emblem of the University that offered the course as well. When you pay for the course the University uses methods like tracing your typing pattern and photographs to identify you. This basically is an added measure to ensure that the student does not cheat thus making the certificate a little more valid.

Despite a lot of criticism, many people rely on MOOCs. If you're not after certificates but rather interested in growing your knowledge on a subject,